

- Classic shirts for men and blouses for women: one tailored, and a softer option
- A well-tailored pant goes a long way: a classic flat front pant for men and the now ubiquitous chino for a more casual option
- Three to four great dresses for women: one LBD, one neutral, one solid colour and one print.

Stylist's slashed-price wardrobe

You might remember Melina Bagnato-Giannuzzi from Channel Seven's *My Kitchen Rules* in 2013 – she was the domestic goddess with hot-blooded Mediterranean flair. Only one thing more delicious than her cooking is her fashion taste. I also know Bagnato-Giannuzzi as a personal stylist who specialises in wardrobe editing – that is, cutting back – and as the daughter of legendary menswear designer Dom Bagnato. It's important to have the confidence, she says, to know your own style, which will avoid 'impulsive' or 'unsure' purchases; and if you have heavily invested in your clothing over years of splurging, treat it like a resource to be tapped.

Bagnato-Giannuzzi always looks impeccable, and here she shares her tips for how to do so without great expense:

- **Two pairs of jeans**
When you find a great pair, double up. 'I'd recommend a pair that costs between \$69.95 and \$120; anything over and you're simply paying the brand for their overheads. You want a couple of quality, affordable and guilt-free pairs.'
- **A pair of shoes for each season (autumn/winter, spring/summer)**
'I recommend going for a Brazilian-, Italian-or Turkish-made – the quality and styles are amazing and don't break the bank. Otherwise you're paying the same for cheaper, China-made shoes. I think spending \$150 to \$299 on a pair of shoes each season is needed.'
- **A blazer or a denim jacket**
'It depends on your personal style, but they complement everyone and you can create so many different combinations – from a boho look, to edgy, sophisticated and classic.'